

Vladimir Golubev

STAFF / SENIOR BACKEND ENGINEER

Backend engineer → tech lead. I'm the one fuzzy specs go to die.

13+ yrs backend engineering | 7,000 req/sec | stats core live 10+ yrs | payment gateways | microservices | MongoDB | PostgreSQL | AWS

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Summary

Backend engineer turned technical lead — 13+ years building, scaling and owning production systems, with team-leadership and lead/architect responsibilities since 2018. I design high-load distributed backends and I'm accountable for the architectural decisions behind them.

Plain version of what I do: requirements analysis and system design (I'd rather pick a fuzzy spec apart for an hour than ship a bug for a month), architecture trade-off decisions (monolith vs. microservices, relational SQL vs. column-store — I choose by load, not by trend), and the documentation, code review and testing discipline that keep systems alive for years.

PROOF POINTS

- Designed and scaled a multi-tenant **CPA (cost-per-action / affiliate marketing) platform** whose API peaked at **7,000 requests per second**.
- A real-time **statistics / analytics core** I architected in 2016 is still running in production a decade later.
- Integrated **four payment gateways end-to-end** (payment processing / billing integration).
- Early adopter of **ClickHouse** for analytics; drove team-wide adoption of Vue.js and Docker.

AI-augmented development as a default, not a novelty. I use Claude / Claude Code, ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Cursor and Codex daily, and I own the agentic harness end-to-end. I stress-test AI-assisted workflows in my solo indie game studio (nomorecare.gg), where I am sole architect, engineer and operator.

Core stack: PHP (5–8), Laravel, system design, microservices, distributed systems, AWS, ClickHouse, Terraform, Docker, Redis; relational and NoSQL databases (MySQL, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, ClickHouse, MongoDB, Couchbase, DynamoDB, OpenSearch).

Open to Tech Lead, Software Architect and Staff Engineer roles where trade-offs and decisions matter more than volume of code. Remote-first, based in Novi Sad, Serbia, on Belgrade time (CET/CEST, UTC+1/+2). Available B2B via a Georgian individual entrepreneur; also open to employment under Serbian labour law. English C1, Russian native.

Work Experience

Senior Backend Engineer / Tech Lead — Quintegro · Jul 2022 – Jun 2026 · Remote Technical lead and senior backend engineer across confidential automotive analytics and marketplace products. • As tech lead and senior backend engineer, designed from scratch the backend for a rare-vehicle market analytics service: processed 300,000+ historical sale records, produced aggregates across multiple market dimensions, and delivered date-aware currency conversion, watched-data alerts and request-history recommendations. • On a confidential RV marketplace with 20,000 active listings, moved image processing out of the request path into background jobs, delivering a several-fold speed-up for multi-image upload workflows. • Built a local development framework for a 43-microservice fleet, saving roughly 15–20 minutes on every validation iteration and removing contention around one shared dev environment used by four developers and two QA engineers. • Implemented automated abuse controls that fully stopped a coordinated spam-registration campaign; also rewrote an in-house DynamoDB library from raw arrays into a query-builder API. • Owned production releases and incident recovery across both products. Technical Leadership, System Design, Microservices, Distributed Systems, PHP, Laravel, MariaDB, AWS, DynamoDB, OpenSearch, CloudWatch, Terraform, Release Management, Incident Recovery
Senior Backend Developer — Playkot · Jul 2021 – Jun 2022 · St. Petersburg Backend engineer on a live mobile-game backend under production traffic: implemented multi-provider authentication with account linking, and optimised partial-load / lazy-loading patterns over MongoDB for hot player data (performance optimisation under load). PHP, MongoDB, NoSQL, Authentication, Game Backend, Performance Optimization
Senior Backend Developer — Rabota.ru · Oct 2020 – Jun 2021 · St. Petersburg Backend engineer on one of Russia's largest job boards (high-traffic web platform): built the in-account customer notification service, migrated client-account features off a legacy codebase onto the new internal framework (legacy modernisation), and extended automated-test coverage across PostgreSQL-backed services. PHP, PostgreSQL, Notifications, Legacy Migration / Modernization, Test Automation

Lead Backend (PHP) Developer — Smart Line · Apr 2015 – Oct 2020 · St. Petersburg
Grew a small internal PHP utility into offergate.pro — a multi-tenant **CPA (cost-per-action / affiliate marketing) platform** with two product surfaces and a ClickHouse analytics stack.

- Designed a real-time **statistics / analytics core** in 2016 that still runs in production today; the platform API peaked at **7,000 requests per second** (high-load system design).
 - Led a small backend team from 2018: code review, mentoring, architectural sign-off, and a team-wide rollout of automated testing.
 - Early ClickHouse adopter for analytics; initiated the team's migration to Vue.js and containerisation with Docker.
 - Integrated **four payment gateways end-to-end** — WebMoney, Patron, ePayments, bank131 (payment processing / billing integration).
- Technical Leadership, Team Leadership, Mentoring, System Design, High-Load Systems, PHP 7, Laravel, Vue.js, ClickHouse, MariaDB, Redis, Couchbase, Docker, Payment Gateway Integration

Full-Stack Engineer — TAXOFT · Jan 2013 – Mar 2015 · St. Petersburg
Designed, built and maintained the full software stack of a taxi-aggregator / ride-hailing service end-to-end — first hands-on exposure to production scale and on-call operations.
PHP, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, MySQL, Full-Stack Development

Projects

No More Care — Founder / Solo Engineer

nomorecare.gg →

Solo (one-person) indie game studio with three roguelike games in development — sole owner of design, software architecture, code, infrastructure and release.
Used as a **real-world test bed for agentic AI / LLM-assisted (“AI-in-the-loop”) development workflows**.

Skills

PINNED

System Design

High-Load Systems

Backend Engineering

architecture & systems System design, Software architecture, Distributed systems, Microservices, Monolithic architecture, High-load / high-throughput systems, Scalability, Performance optimization, API design, REST APIs

languages & runtime PHP (5, 7, 8), Laravel, JavaScript, SQL, Python (beginner, pipelines)

data ClickHouse, MySQL, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Couchbase, DynamoDB, OpenSearch, Redis, NoSQL, Relational databases, Column-store databases, Database design

cloud & infra AWS, Docker, Terraform, CloudWatch, CI/CD, Linux, Infrastructure as Code

domains Payment gateway integration, Billing / payment processing, Affiliate / CPA platforms, Marketplaces, Analytics / statistics platforms, Game backends, Notifications

quality PHPUnit, Behat / BDD (behavior-driven development), Test automation, Technical documentation

leadership Technical leadership, Team leadership, Mentoring, Code review, Architectural sign-off / decision ownership, Release management

roles / seniority Technical Lead, Software Architect, Staff Engineer, Senior Backend Engineer, Engineering Team Lead

ai-augmented development Claude / Claude Code, ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Codex, Agentic AI, LLM-assisted development, Agentic frameworks, Full-cycle AI product delivery, OpenHands SDK, LLM fine-tuning, Local LLM setup: OpenHands SDK + LM Studio, Python pipelines

frontend (working level) Vue.js, HTML, CSS, JavaScript

languages Russian (native), English (C1)